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NVIDIA Tegra

Nintendo might grab NVIDIA's Tegra to power their upcoming handhelds

Graphic Cards Test

Contact Sheet

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visible and the Sapphire Radeon HD 5870 wins out *Best Buy* award for a very good price to performance ratio – something the GTX 295 cannot achieve. The *Best Performer* award goes to the ZOTAC GTX 295 for its slightly lower price than the ASUS and XFX GTX 295 cards that had nearly identical performance.

The game continues...

With DX 11 just around the bend, and a slew of new DX 11 titles already promising to line shelves before the year is out, there is much happening in the PC gaming space. For everyone who embraced consoles and wrote off PC gaming as history, the proverbial finger has been flashed by the industry, as it, as a whole fights back. The fact that no console can offer the

visual quality and flexibility that a PC offers is something console fans have ignored. DX11, it seems, will restate the part about image quality. And for the first time, this occurs without the accompanied performance hit – DX 11 titles run 30 per cent faster than their DX 10 versions. AMD is first to market with a DX 11 part as the Radeon HD 58xx and 57xx cards have been birthed from their 40 nm womb. We've tested the Radeon HD 5870 and Radeon HD 5770 and they're really interesting to say the very least.

Into this seemingly bright future comes the proverbial cloud – wilful sabotage on the part of game developers. We've seen titles optimised for a particular brand and to be honest this is part of the industry as aid whether financial

or in terms of development or problem-solving / hurdle-overcoming is rendered (pun!) to developers. But aggressive marketing plays play spoilsport. After all, when working with a developer to optimise a game for ones hardware, it's all too easy to implement techniques to limit performance and/or visual quality on competitors products and quite honestly, this is sad for the gaming industry as a whole. One such example is the game *Batman Arkham Asylum* – an excellent title in every respect and optimised for NVIDIA cards. When we tried to benchmark this title on AMD hardware we were surprised to see its abysmal performance in terms of fps. Not only this, but we were unable to set any sort of antialiasing and without this the game loses its visual appeal; worse

still this seems intentional. NVIDIA cards can run FSAA on a selective (need) basis that varies scene to scene and of course MSAA can also be used. Sadly, ATI cards can do nothing here and even a Radeon 5870 is slowed to a crawl – slower than a GeForce 9800 GTX. Needless to say we dropped this otherwise spectacular title from our test repertoire. And both parties have been guilty of such tomfoolery in the past, a disturbing trend we're hoping (against all hope) will cease. After all gaming is different things to different people – a sport, a hobby as well as a leisurely activity and we're happy to report that the industry is growing. But it needs to grow as a whole and the pie's large enough for everyone to get a healthy slice, so play nice... **d**

You Need

A cheap multi-GPU solution

We Recommend



Galaxy GTS 250 x 2 (SLI)
Rs. 6,300 x 2 = Rs. 12,600

Things to check

Does your motherboard support both SLI and Crossfire? You need a PSU with four PCIe power cables

You Need

Something that will play all games with high settings at a resolution of 1680 x 1050

We Recommend



ZOTAC GTX 285
Rs. 21,000

Things to check

At least a 500 watt power supply from a good brand and a well ventilated cabinet

You Need

Something that will play all games with high settings at a resolution of 1920 x 1200 with FSAA enabled

We Recommend



ZOTAC GeForce GTX 295
Rs. 30,500

Things to check

At least a 600 watt power supply and a high-end cabinet to dissipate all the heat

You Need

The fast gaming solution available, price no bar

We Recommend



ZOTAC GTX 295 x 2 (SLI)
Rs. 30,500 x 2 = Rs. 61,000

Things to check

A high-end 850 watt PSU and a high-end cabinet, a core i7 CPU and an SLI-ready X58 mobo